

# Genre, purpose, and audience

ALL NONFICTION TEXTS HAVE A CLEAR GENRE, PURPOSE, AND AUDIENCE.

Writers need to consider what type of text they are writing, as well as for whom they are writing and why. These factors influence the presentation style and language used.

## Genre

A nonfiction text is one based on facts, rather than a story. The different types, or genres, of nonfiction text all have their own features and conventions. For example, a newspaper or magazine article will have a headline at the top and text written in columns, whereas a letter includes the sender's address at the top.

Newspaper stories are written in columns with a headline at the top.

Leaflets are sheets of paper folded into three, with information on each segment.

Letters can be formal or informal, but both types are laid out with the sender's address at the top.

## Purpose

The purpose of a text is the reason that it was written. For example, an encyclopedia entry about Paris is supposed to inform the reader, whereas an advertisement for a vacation in Paris is intended to persuade the reader to visit. Even though they are about the same subject, these two texts would have very different features.

- Sometimes a text can be written for **more than one purpose**. An advertisement for pimple cream might give customers **advice** about their skin, but will also try to **persuade** them to buy the product.

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◀ 180–181 Effective communication

◀ 182–183 Picking the right words

◀ 186–187 Planning and research

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192–193 ▶

